SAN DIEGO HOUSING COMMISSION

We're About People

San Diego Housing Commission
Request for Proposals (RFP)

RFP #: IT-26-07

Description: Website Redesign Services

Release Date: February 19, 2026

Submittal Deadline: March 12, 2026

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San Diego Housing Commission
1122 Broadway, Suite 300
San Diego, CA 92101

SUMMARY STATEMENT

The San Diego Housing Commission (the Commission) is soliciting proposals from businesses (herein after referred to as Proposer(s)) to provide Website Redesign Services. A full description of the requested service requirements is set forth in the Scope of Services section of this Request for Proposals (RFP).

A. RFP ATTACHMENTS

The following items are attached as separate documents to this RFP:

1. Proposal Submittal Documents
2. Sample Contract

B. IMPORTANT INFORMATION AND DUE DATES

Events	Information/Due Dates
Term of Contract	One year plus one one-year option.
Pre-Proposal Conference	2/26/2026 at 1:00 p.m. PT
Requests for Interpretation	5 business days prior to proposal due date
HUD Section 3 Regulations	Proposer must begin contacting the Commission's certified Section 3 Business Concerns no later than 3/4/2026
Proposal Due	3/12/2026 at 3:00 p.m. PT
Interviews	3/26/2026 from 10:00 a.m. to 1:30 p.m. PT

C. PRE-PROPOSAL CONFERENCE

A non-mandatory pre-proposal conference will be held on 2/26/2026 at 1:00 p.m. Pacific Time via Microsoft Teams Meeting.

Microsoft Teams meeting
Join: https://teams.microsoft.com/meet/2177051302795?p=AgOqCUsUqXGH8WHvGO
Meeting ID: 217 705 130 279 5
Passcode: gv9gx2FF

Need help? | System reference
Dial in by phone
+1 619-614-6098,,119199756# United States, Chula Vista
Find a local number
Phone conference ID: 119 199 756#
For organizers: Meeting options | Reset dial-in PIN

D. INTERVIEWS

The Commission reserves the right to conduct interviews with short-listed proposers. If interviews are held, they will occur between 10:00 a.m. and 1:30 p.m. Pacific Time on March 26, 2026. Proposer interviews will be held virtually. Proposers must ensure availability during this time.

Failure to attend an interview, if requested, may result in the proposal being deemed nonresponsive.

E. REQUESTS FOR INTERPRETATION AND CLARIFICATION

Requests for interpretation will be issued in the form of a written addendum to all prospective proposers and will become part of the RFP. No questions will be answered on the day of the proposal due date.

All requests for clarification of specifications or questions related to this RFP, if any, must be directed to Kareen Escobedo at kareene@sdhc.org. Clarifications will only be made in writing by the Contracting Officer.

F. EXCEPTIONS TO RFP AND/OR SAMPLE CONTRACT

Proposer is expected to read and understand all terms and conditions of this RFP and the sample contract included in this invitation, and by the act of submitting a proposal, agrees to their terms and conditions. If Proposer takes any exception(s) to any portion of the RFP and/or the sample contract, the specific portion to which exception(s) is/are taken must be specifically identified and explained. Any such exceptions must be submitted by Proposer in their proposal as separate attachment entitled "Exceptions to RFP/Sample Contract." Failure to specifically identify and submit in writing any exceptions to the RFP and/or sample contract within the proposal will be deemed a waiver of any objection. Any exceptions made to the RFP and/or sample contract terms, conditions, provisions, etc., will be considered during the proposal evaluation process.

G. CONFLICT OF INTERTEST OR PENDING LITIGATION

Proposer must, in their submitted "Letter of Introduction," describe any arrangements, formal or informal, that Proposer has with any other party that might interfere with Proposer's ability to provide independent and unbiased advice and assistance under this RFP. Describe any litigation, administrative proceedings, or investigations in which Proposer is involved or to which it is subject that might have an adverse effect on its ability to fulfill its engagement under this RFP or that may affect the Commission's perception of its suitability.

H. PROPOSAL SUBMISSION

Proposals must be submitted via the PlanetBids portal no later than 3/12/2026 at 3:00 p.m. Pacific Time. Late responses will not be accepted. All responses must include completed *Proposal Submittal Documents* and be clearly identified as "RFP IT-26-07 Website Redesign Services."

The Commission reserves the right to reject any or all proposal responses, waive any informality in the specifications or solicitation process, or cancel in whole or in part this RFP if it is determined by the Commission that it is in the best interest of the Commission to do so.

I. HUD SECTION 3 REGULATIONS

This project is subject to Housing and Urban Development (HUD) Section 3 regulations (24CFR75). If Proposer plans to award subcontracts for the performance or support of this project, Proposer must make a documented good faith effort to reach out to and award the subcontracting opportunities to Section 3 Business Concerns certified by the Commission.

At a minimum, supporting documentation shall include a log of calls or copies of emails—with outcomes—to the Commission's certified Section 3 Business Concerns and notifying the Commission's Section 3 Unit of employment opportunities for the Commission's certified Section 3 Workers. The registry of certified Section 3 Business Concerns and "Examples of Efforts to Award Contracting Opportunities" are available at:

https://www.sdhc.org/doing-business-with-us/section-3/

Proposer must begin contacting the certified Section 3 Business Concerns no later than 3/4/2026.

SCOPE OF SERVICES

The main purpose of the Commission's website is to provide a user-friendly and intuitive platform that is easy to navigate, removes barriers to public access, enhances customer service, expands outreach opportunities, and promotes transparency

The proposed redesign will provide the following:

1. Full compliance with accessibility and language requirements, including but not limited to Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) Version 2.1, Level AA, translation through Google Translate, and user-enabled accessibility adjustments.

2. Enhanced user experience
    - Simplified menus for quick access to key information
    - Easy navigation with clear pathways for all user types
    - Mobile-responsive design optimized for all devices
    - Intuitive layout that supports logical content flow
    - Engaging interface with visually appealing elements
    - Accurate, clear search functionality that recognizes queries and returns relevant results

3. The website must support interactive forms that allow visitors to submit information directly to the Commission. This functionality should include:
    - Submission tracking to monitor and manage incoming data
    - Email-based data delivery, ensuring submitted information is sent securely to designated Commission email addresses

4. The solution should provide tools for Analytics and Reporting to:
    - Track user behavior and engagement
    - Generate reports for performance monitoring
    - Support data-driven decision-making
    - If analytics tools are not integrated into the solution, the website must support industry-standard analytics platforms (e.g., Google Analytics, Adobe Analytics) for seamless implementation.

5. The redesigned website must incorporate best practices for Comprehensive Search Engine Optimization (SEO) Strategy to maximize visibility and search performance. This includes:
    - Technical optimization for site speed, indexing, and crawlability
    - Keyword strategy aligned with the Commission's goals and audience
    - Performance monitoring to track and improve search rankings over time.

6. The website must implement industry-standard security measures and be deployed in a secure, third-party hosted environment. Requirements include:
    - SSL encryption for all data transmissions
    - Secure form submissions and data storage
    - Compliance with applicable privacy regulations
    - Third-party hosting solution that ensures reliability, scalability, and security

7. Simplified administrative and management experience
    - Content management
    - Ease of use / full content access.

8. The new design will use the current Commission's logo and color palette.

9. The proposed solution must include an optional integration of an AI-powered, agentic digital assistant into the public website. The assistant should demonstrate autonomous, goal-oriented behavior beyond basic prompt-response functionality, including the ability to reason, plan, and execute multistep tasks to assist users effectively. Costs associated with this optional integration must be itemized and presented separately in the proposal.

10. Future-Ready Design for AI Integration. Even if the optional AI-powered digital assistant (Item 9) is not implemented immediately, the website design and architecture must lay the foundation for future integration. This includes:
    - Flexible, modular architecture that supports adding advanced features without major redesign
    - Scalable infrastructure to accommodate AI-driven functionality later
    - API-ready design for seamless integration with future AI services
    - Organize and optimize content for use with AI-powered, natural language digital assistant

Deliverables and Approval Requirements

The Contractor shall provide the following specific deliverables as part of the phased approach. The Contractor must obtain written approval from the Commission at the conclusion of each phase before proceeding to the next phase.

Phase 1: Discovery
- Review the existing hosting environment (the Commission will provide access) to assess current infrastructure and requirements.
- Conduct stakeholder meetings and departmental consultations to gather requirements.

Phase 2: Design
- Work with the Commission's teams and departments to design the new website.

- Develop a pattern library with code for consistent design standards.
- Create multiple custom page templates as needed.
- Ensure the design is user-friendly and intuitive, allowing quick access to information and services.
- Incorporate a comprehensive SEO strategy, including technical optimization, keyword planning, and performance monitoring.

Phase 3: Build

- Address all CMS requirements and website selection criteria.
- Move the current site to a secure, third-party hosted facility as-is, if hosting changes are required.
- Migrate existing data to the new site.
- Implement accessibility compliance (WCAG 2.1 AA).
- Integrate security measures and confirm compatibility with industry-standard analytics tools.

Phase 4: Site Launch

- Finalize testing and quality assurance.
- Deploy the new website to the production environment.
- Validate functionality and performance post-launch.

Phase 5: Project Completion

- Provide documentation and training for the Commission's staff.
- Deliver final project report and confirm all contractual deliverables.
- Obtain the Commissions' formal acceptance.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

After the proposal submission deadline, all responses will be reviewed by an Evaluation Selection Committee. The Committee will score and rank the proposals based on the criteria outlined below. Proposers are expected to ensure that their submittal documents clearly address each criterion and align with the scope of services and contract deliverables as described in this RFP. The Committee will recommend, in order of preference, the firms deemed to be the most responsible, responsive, and advantageous to the Commission.

CRITERIA	POINTS
I. Cost Proposal/Compensation 1. Explanation for proposed costs 2. Reasonableness of proposed costs 3. Maintenance and support costs	25
II. Strategic/Business Criteria 1. Alignment with the Commissions mission and goals	10
III. Capability and Functionality 1. Ensure accessibility compliance (WCAG 2.1 AA) and language support. 2. Enhance user experience with intuitive navigation and mobile optimization. 3. Provide robust forms and submission functionality. 4. Enable analytics and reporting. 5. Implement a comprehensive SEO strategy. 6. Maintain strong security and privacy. 7. Support third-party hosting. 8. Offer content management capabilities. 9. Integrate an AI-powered, agentic digital assistant. 10. Design for future-ready AI integration.	30
IV. Vendor Considerations 1. Experience with government/public sector websites 2. Accessibility and SEO expertise 3. Customer retention and references 4. Experience with AI Integration	20

V. Assurances of Nondiscrimination Proposer shall demonstrate its compliance with federal and state (as applicable) nondiscrimination regulations and policies. Provide a narrative detailing Proposer's knowledge, experience and demonstrated commitment to refrain from unfair treatment and proactive inclusion of all protected classes as outlined in federal regulations both from an employment and subcontracting perspective. Include specific examples of proactive activities and initiatives, which may include but are not limited to: • Knowledge in the principles and practices of nondiscrimination regulation requirements. • Recruitment/workplace practices, engagement and outreach efforts to ensure Proposer is not unlawfully discriminating in its recruitment, promotion and other related Human Resources activities. • Outreach and engagement efforts to ensure Proposer is not unlawfully discriminating in its subcontracting opportunities.	15
Total Possible Points	**100 Points**

INSTRUCTIONS TO PROPOSERS

A. REFERENCES

All references to Housing Authority/Agency (HA), Public Housing Agency (PHA), and Indian Housing Agency (IHA) in the following document (Form 5369-B) should be read to mean the San Diego Housing Commission.

Instructions to Proposers Non-Construction

U.S. Department of Housing and Urban Development
Office of Public and Indian Housing

- 03291 -

1. **Preparation of Offers**

(a) Proposers are expected to examine the statement of work, the proposed contract terms and conditions, and all instructions. Failure to do so will be at the Proposer's risk.

(b) Each Proposer shall furnish the information required by the solicitation. The Proposer shall sign the offer and print or type its name on the cover sheet and each continuation sheet on which it makes an entry. Erasures or other changes must be initialed by the person signing the offer. Offers signed by an agent shall be accompanied by evidence of that agent's authority, unless that evidence has been previously furnished to the HA.

(c) Offers for services other than those specified will not be considered.

2. Submission of Offers

(a) Offers and modifications thereof shall be submitted in sealed envelopes or packages (1) addressed to the office specified in the solicitation, and (2) showing the time specified for receipt, the solicitation number, and the name and address of the Proposer.

(b) Telegraphic offers will not be considered unless authorized by the solicitation; however, offers may be modified by written or telegraphic notice.

(c) Facsimile offers, modifications or withdrawals will not be considered unless authorized by the solicitation.

3. Amendments to Solicitations

(a) If this solicitation is amended, then all terms and conditions which are not modified remain unchanged.

(b) Proposers shall acknowledge receipt of any amendments to this solicitation by

(1) Signing and returning the amendment;
(2) identifying the amendment number and date in the space provided for this purpose on the form for submitting an offer,
(3) letter or telegram, or
(4) facsimile, if facsimile offers are authorized in the solicitation. The HA/HUD must receive the acknowledgment by the time specified for receipt of offers.

4. Explanation to Prospective Proposers

Any prospective Proposer desiring an explanation or interpretation of the solicitation, statement of work, etc., must request it in writing soon enough to allow a reply to reach all prospective offers before the submission of their offers. Oral explanations or instructions given before the award of the contract will not be binding. Any information given to a prospective Proposer concerning a solicitation will be furnished promptly to all other prospective offers as an amendment of the solicitation, if that information is necessary in submitting offers or if the lack of it would be prejudicial to any other prospective Proposers.

5. Responsibility of Prospective Contractor

(a) The HA shall award a contract only to a responsible prospective contractor who is able to perform successfully under the terms and conditions of the proposed contract. To be determined responsible, a prospective contractor must -

(1) Have adequate financial resources to perform the contract, or the ability to obtain them;
(2) Have a satisfactory performance record;
(3) Have a satisfactory record of integrity and business ethics;
(4) Have a satisfactory record of compliance with public policy (e.g., Equal Employment Opportunity); and
(5) Not have been suspended, debarred, or otherwise determined to be ineligible for award of contracts by the Department of Housing and Urban Development or any other agency of the U.S. Government. Current lists of ineligible contractors are available for inspection at the HA/HUD.

(b) Before an offer is considered for award, the Proposer may be requested by the HA to submit a statement or other documentation regarding any of the foregoing requirements. Failure by the Proposer to provide such additional information may render the Proposer ineligible for award.

6. Late Submissions, Modifications, and Withdrawal of Offers

(a) Any offer received at the place designated in the solicitation after the exact time specified for receipt will not be considered unless it is received before award is made and it -

(1) Was sent by registered or certified mail not later than the fifth calendar day before the date specified for receipt of offers (e.g., an offer submitted in response to a solicitation requiring receipt of offers by the 20th of the month must have been mailed by the 15th);
(2) Was sent by mail, or if authorized by the solicitation was sent by telegram or via facsimile, and it is determined by the HA/ HUD that the late receipt was due solely to mishandling by the HA/HUD after receipt at the HA;
(3) Was sent by U.S. Postal Service Express Mail Next Day Service - Post Office to Addressee, not later than 5:00 p.m. at the place of mailing two working days prior to the date specified for receipt of proposals. The term "working days" excludes weekends and U.S. Federal holidays; or
(4) Is the only offer received.

(b) Any modification of an offer, except a modification resulting from the

HA's request for "best and final" offer (if this solicitation is a request for proposals), is subject to the same conditions as in subparagraph (a)(1), (2), and (3) of this provision.

(c) A modification resulting from the HA's request for "best and final" offer received after the time and date specified in the request will not be considered unless received before award and the late receipt is due,

solely to mishandling by the HA after receipt at the HA.

(d) The only acceptable evidence to establish the date of mailing of late offer, modification, or withdrawal sent either by registered or certified mail is the U.S. or Canadian Postal Service postmark both on the envelope or wrapper and on the original receipt from the U.S. or Canadian Postal Service. Both postmarks must show a legible date or the offer, modification, or withdrawal shall be processed as if mailed late. "Postmark" means a printed, stamped, or otherwise place impression (exclusive of a postage meter machine impression) that readily identifiable without further action as having been supplied and fixed by employees of the U.S. or Canadian Postal Service on the date of mailing. Therefore, Proposers should request the postal clerk place a hand Cancellation bull's-eye postmark on both the receipt and the envelope or wrapper.

(e) The only acceptable evidence to establish the time of receipt at the HA is the time/date stamp of HA on the offer wrapper or other documentary evidence of receipt maintained by the HA.

(f) The only acceptable evidence to establish the date of mailing of a late offer, modification, or withdrawal sent by Express Mail Next Day Service-Post Office to Addressee is the date entered by the post office receiving clerk on the "Express Mail Next Day Service-Post Office to Addressee" label and the postmark on both the envelope or wrapper and on the original receipt from the U.S. Postal Service. "Postmark" has the same meaning as defined in paragraph (c) of this provision, excluding postmarks of the Canadian Postal Service. Therefore, Proposers should request the postal clerk to place a legible hand cancellation bull's eye postmark on both the receipt and the envelope or wrapper.

(g) Notwithstanding paragraph (a) of his provision, a late modification of an otherwise successful offer that makes its terms more favorable to the HA will be considered at any time it is received and may be accepted.

(h) If this solicitation is a request for proposals, proposals may be withdrawn by written notice, or if authorized by this solicitation, by telegram (including mailgram) or facsimile machine transmission received at any time before award. Proposals may be withdrawn in person by a Proposer or its authorized representative if the identify of the person requesting withdrawal is established and the person signs a receipt for the offer before award. If this solicitation is an invitation for bids, bids may be withdrawn at any time prior to bid opening.

7. Contract Award

(a) The HA will award a contract resulting from this solicitation to the responsible Proposer whose offer conforming to the solicitation will be most advantageous to the HA, cost or price and other factors, specified elsewhere in this solicitation, considered.

(b) The HA may

(1) Reject any or all offers if such action is in the HA's interest,
(2) accept other than the lowest offer,
(3) waive informalities and minor irregularities in offers received, and
(4) award more than one contract for all or part of the requirements stated.

(c) If this solicitation is a request for proposals, the HA may award a contract on the basis of initial offers received, without discussions. Therefore, each initial offer should contain the Proposer's best terms from a cost or price and technical standpoint.

(d) A written award or acceptance of offer mailed or otherwise furnished to the successful Proposer within the time for acceptance specified in the offer shall result in a binding contract without further action by either party. If this solicitation is a request for proposals, before the offer's specified expiration time, the HA may accept an offer, whether or not there are negotiations after its receipt, unless a written, notice of withdrawal is received before award. Negotiations conducted after receipt of an offer do not constitute a rejection or counteroffer by the HA.

(e) Neither financial data submitted with an offer, nor representations concerning facilities or financing, will form a part of the resulting contract.

8. Service of Protest

Any protest against the award of a contract pursuant to this solicitation shall be served on the HA by obtaining written and dated acknowledgement of receipt from the HA at the address shown on the cover of this solicitation. The determination of the HA with regard to such protest or to proceed to award notwithstanding such protest shall be final unless appealed by the protestor.

9. Offer Submission

Offers shall be submitted as follows and shall be enclosed in a sealed envelope and addressed to the office specified in the solicitation. The proposal shall show the hour and date specified in the solicitation for receipt, the solicitation number, and the name and address of the Proposer, on the face of the envelope.

It is very important that the offer be properly identified on the face of the envelope as set forth above in order to insure that the date and time of receipt is stamped on the face of the offer envelope. Receiving procedures are: date and time stamp those envelopes identified as proposals and deliver them immediately to the appropriate contracting official, and only date stamp those envelopes which do not contain identification of the contents and deliver them to the appropriate procuring activity only through the routine mail delivery procedure.

B. RESPONSIBLE PROPOSER

"Responsible Proposer" is defined as a proposer who has met all requirements of the Instructions to Proposers, including financial resources to perform the contract or the ability to obtain them; a satisfactory record of integrity and business ethics; ability to comply with the proposed delivery or performance schedule; a satisfactory performance record; and qualifications and eligibility to receive an award under applicable laws and regulations.

C. TERM OF CONTRACT

The specific contract term, scope of work and costs/pricing are subject to negotiations between the Commission and the successful Contractor. These terms are subject to change until a contract has been executed.

D. SCOPE OF SERVICES

The scope of required services for this solicitation is detailed in RFP section "Scope of Services."

E. WEIGHTED RATING SYSTEM

The Commission reserves the right to establish proposal evaluation criteria and to utilize a weighted rating and ranking system for evaluating the overall sufficiency of each proposal in meeting specifications. In submitting a proposal, Proposer acknowledges that in a weighted rating and ranking system, lowest price may not be the deciding factor. The proposal with the highest evaluated ranking by the Evaluation Selection Committee, based on the evaluation criteria set forth herein, will be the company/companies selected for contract award recommendation.

F. SELECTION PROCESS

Selection of the most responsive and qualified proposer(s) for contract award consideration will be made after the Evaluation Selection Committee has reviewed, evaluated, scored and ranked the proposals received.

G. AWARD OF CONTRACT

a. Identification of the successful proposer(s) will not be determined at proposal opening. The Commission reserves the right to obtain opinion of Counsel regarding the legality and sufficiency of proposals before the Commission makes an award selection determination. Contracts will be awarded, if at all, to the highest-scored, responsible proposer(s) within 120 days of final date of receiving proposals. Contract(s) will be entered into effective within 10 days after written notice of award has been given to the successful proposer(s). Certificates of insurance, if required, must be received prior to contracts being made available for signature.
b. The Commission reserves the right to award multiple contracts to multiple firms if the Commission determines that it is in its best interest to do so.
c. It is the intent of the Commission to enter into contract and cost negotiations with the most qualified and highest ranked firm(s) as evaluated, scored and ranked by the Evaluation Selection Committee. If a mutually acceptable contract cannot be negotiated between the Commission and the highest ranked firm, the Commission will invite the next highest ranked firm(s) to enter into negotiations. This process will continue until a mutually acceptable agreement(s) is consummated or the Commission cancels the solicitation.
d. The Commission will be under no obligation to utilize any or all of Contractor's services

contemplated under the contract, nor is the Commission required to expend the entire contract amount set forth in the contract.

e. Any contract(s) awarded by the Commission pursuant to this RFP that exceeds $250,000.00 must be approved by the Board of Commissioners of the San Diego Housing Commission. Additionally, any contract awarded with an amount that exceeds the sum of $250,000.00 may also be approved by the Housing Authority of the City of San Diego.

H. REJECTION OF PROPOSALS

Any proposal may, at the Commission's discretion, be rejected if it is adjudged incomplete, illegible, or conditional. However, alternate proposals or explanations may be made on separate sheets. Such alternates or explanations will not be considered in determining the proposal but may be used in negotiations after determination of the proposer. All corrections must be initiated by the proposer.

I. DISPUTES AND PROTESTS

Protest of Award: Any protest arising out of the award of a contract from an RFP or RFQ, must be received no later than five business days after notification to an unsuccessful respondent that they were not selected.

Protest of the Commission's Rejection of Response: Any protest of a decision by the Commission to reject a response to formal solicitations (i.e., bid, proposal, or qualifications) in response to a solicitation must be received no later than two business days after being notified in writing of the Commission's decision.

Late Protest: Protests that are not timely received in accordance with the applicable filing deadline set forth in this Section will not be considered.

J. FORMS AND MANNER OF FILING PROTESTS

Form: All protests must be in writing, be clearly identified as a "procurement protest" and be signed by the protesting party. Protests must identify the solicitation at issue, contain a detailed statement of the basis for the protest and include any supporting evidence. Protests lacking signatures or detailed statements of the basis of the protest will not be considered.

Manner of Filing: All protests must be filed with the Commission's Procurement Department electronically to the attention of George Williams, Interim Vice President of Procurement and Labor Compliance, at Georgew@sdhc.org.

K. STATEMENT OF ECONOMIC INTEREST DISCLOSURE FORM

Proposer must assure that each Proposer's principal that will be supervising Proposer's work under the contract will file a completed and executed Statement of Economic Interest Disclosure Form (Form 700) with the City Clerk's Office of the City of San Diego at the following times:

a. Within 30 days of execution of the contract;
b. Annually on or before April 1 of each year; and
c. Within 30 days after completion of the contract or departure, reassignment, or termination of principal.

Filing may be submitted electronically, through the City Clerk's Office electronic filing system eFile San Diego. Proposer must email a copy of the filed Form 700, for each filer, to Cassie Li cassiel@sdhc.org within five business days of filing in accordance with the requirements of General Provision 31 (a), (b) or (c) as applicable.

END OF RFP